

N01 FRUITS AND VEGETABLES | P

Intent : Promote the consumption of fruits and vegetables by increasing the availability and accessibility of fruits and vegetables.

Summary : This WELL feature requires the provision and promotion of fruits and vegetables, if food is sold or provided on a daily basis.

Issue : Fruits and vegetables are a key component of a healthy dietary pattern for the prevention of chronic disease.¹ However, most individuals around the world do not meet the daily recommended five servings (400 g).¹ Insufficient fruit and vegetable intake is attributed to 5.2 million deaths worldwide in 2013, as well as 14% of gastrointestinal cancer deaths, 11% of ischemic heart disease deaths and 9% of stroke deaths globally.² Greater consumption of fruits and vegetables is associated with a reduced risk of cardiovascular disease, obesity, type 2 diabetes, stroke and certain types of cancers, as well as improved weight management.^{1,3–5} Eating a variety of fruits and vegetables also helps to ensure adequate nutrient, micronutrient and dietary fiber intake.⁶

Solutions : Increasing the availability and access of fruits and vegetables can support fruit and vegetable consumption. Increased availability of fresh fruit at worksites has been shown to improve fruit and vegetable consumption at work and at home, indicating that individuals take these healthier habits home.⁷ Strategies to increase fruit and vegetable consumption include behavioral interventions, such as increased availability and visibility of fruits and vegetables, pricing incentives to lower the cost of fruits and vegetables and promotion and support of community gardens and urban agriculture initiatives.⁸

PART 1 PROVIDE FRUITS AND VEGETABLES

For All Spaces except Commercial Dining Spaces:

Option 1: Food offerings

Each food outlet meets one of the following requirements:

- a. The selection includes at least two different individually selectable fruit offerings (containing no added sugar) and at least two different individually selectable non-fried vegetable offerings.⁹
- b. At least 50% of available food options are individually selectable fruit offerings (containing no added sugar) and/or individually selectable non-fried vegetable offerings.

OR

Option 2: No food offerings

The following requirement is met:

- a. There are no foods sold or provided on a daily basis by (or under contract with) the project owner.

For Commercial Dining Spaces:

One of the following requirements is met:

- a. The selection includes at least four different individually selectable fruit offerings (containing no added sugar) and at least four different individually selectable non-fried vegetable offerings.¹⁰
- b. At least 50% of available food options are individually selectable fruit offerings (containing no added sugar) and/or individually selectable non-fried vegetable offerings.

PART 2 PROMOTE FRUIT AND VEGETABLE VISIBILITY

For All Spaces:

Option 1: Food offerings

Fruit and vegetable offerings sold or provided on a daily basis by (or under contract with) the project owner meet the following requirements:

a.

Fruit and vegetable offerings that are self-serve meet at least one of the following:

- i. Are located at eye-level or just below eye-level.^{9,11,12}
- ii. Are displayed on a countertop, table or other visible surface.¹³
- iii. Are located at point-of-sale or point-of-purchase.^{9,11,12}
- iv. Are located at the end of aisles.^{9,11,12}
- v. Are located at the beginning of food service lines.^{9,11,12}
- vi. Are visible from the food outlet entrance.¹⁴

b.

If food is prepared on-site and presented on menus (including digital menus and menu boards), fruit and vegetable offerings meet at least three of the following:

- i. Are included as default options throughout the menu.¹¹
- ii. Are listed using appealing descriptions.^{15,16}
- iii. Are visually highlighted through icons, different colors or bolding.¹⁷
- iv. Are listed first in each menu section.¹⁷
- v. Are listed in prominent areas of the menu (e.g., the top, bottom, corners).¹⁷

OR

Option 2: No food offerings

The following requirement is met:

- a. There are no foods sold or provided on a daily basis by (or under contract with) the project owner.

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N02 NUTRITIONAL TRANSPARENCY | P

Intent : Help individuals make informed food choices through nutritional labeling and allergy information.

Summary : This WELL feature requires the provision of detailed nutritional information, calorie labeling for standard menu items and sugar content labeling for all foods and beverages sold or provided on a daily basis.

Issue :

Nutrition information panels and nutrition fact labels are often found on packaged foods and beverages. These provide consumers with useful nutrient, ingredient and food allergen information that can be used to guide food choices and daily intake. However, the same level of nutritional transparency does not exist for foods and beverages in restaurants, vending machines and a variety of food retail establishments. Nutritional transparency is especially important for the millions of individuals with food allergies and food intolerances, who must navigate many issues when dining away from home. Moreover, evidence suggests that health warnings can help increase health knowledge and the purchase and consumption of certain products.¹

Solutions : Although evidence is inconsistent as to whether calorie labeling reduces calories purchased or calories consumed, the increased transparency has led to the introduction of lower-calorie items in restaurants and other food establishments.²⁻⁴ Research also suggests that calorie labeling and similar health labeling interventions may serve as important sources of nutritional information for consumers, resulting in healthier food choices and increased calorie information awareness.⁵⁻⁷ Since there is no cure for food allergies, avoidance of food allergens is a recommended strategy for preventing serious allergic reactions, such as anaphylaxis. Food service professionals play a critical role in helping consumers navigate food choices and making all spaces safer and more inclusive of individuals with food allergies and intolerances. Food allergy training helps ensure that all food service staff are properly trained to address potential food allergens and intolerances.

PART 1 PROVIDE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION

For All Spaces:

Option 1: Food offerings

For packaged foods and beverages (including items in vending machines) and self-serve bulk foods, sold or provided on a daily basis by (or under contract with) the project owner, the following nutrition information is clearly displayed at point-of-decision on packaging or adjacent signage:

- a. Total calories per serving or package.
- b. Macronutrient content (total protein, total fat and total carbohydrate) in weight and/or as a percent of the estimated daily requirements (daily values) per serving or package.
- c. Total sugar content per serving or package.

OR

Option 2: No packaged food offerings

The following requirement is met:

- a. There are no packaged foods and beverages sold or provided on a daily basis by (or under contract with) the project owner.

For Commercial Dining Spaces:

For standard menu items sold or provided by (or under contract with) the project owner, the following requirements are met:

- a. The number of calories contained in each standard menu item, as usually prepared and offered for sale, is clearly displayed at the point-of-decision.
- b. The macronutrient content (total protein, total fat and total carbohydrate) and total sugar content of each standard menu item is available upon request.

PART 2 ADDRESS FOOD ALLERGENS

For Commercial Kitchen Spaces:

Food is prepared on-site by (or under contract with) the project owner on a daily basis and the following requirements are met:

- a. All food service staff (including managers, servers and kitchen staff) are offered annual food allergy training that covers, at a minimum, the following topics:⁸
 1. Overview of food allergies.
 2. Anaphylaxis response protocols.
 3. Emergency response protocols.
 4. Communications protocols.
 5. Reducing risk for cross-contact.
 6. Use of recipes and ingredient disclosure.
 7. Knowledge test.
- b. At least one food service staff member who has completed the food allergy training within 12 months is present to handle questions and special requests from individuals about food allergens during hours of operation.

For Commercial Dining Spaces:

Food is prepared on-site by (or under contract with) the project owner on a daily basis and the following requirement

is met: a. Point-of-decision signage is present to encourage individuals to report their food allergies to food service staff.

PART 3 LABEL SUGAR CONTENT

For Commercial Dining Spaces:

Option 1: No high sugar foods

For standard menu items sold or provided by (or under contract with) the project owner, the following requirement is met:

- a. Standard menu items do not contain more than 25 g of sugar per serving.

OR

Option 2: Label high sugar foods

For standard menu items sold or provided by (or under contract with) the project owner, one of the following requirements is met:

- a. The total sugar content for each standard menu item, as usually prepared and offered for sale, is clearly displayed at the point-of-decision (in addition to calories as required in Part 1 of this feature).
- b. Standard menu items containing more than 25 g of sugar per serving are identified by an icon at the point-of-decision, along with an explanation of the icon and the health risks of high sugar intake.

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N03 REFINED INGREDIENTS | O (MAX : 2 PT)

Intent : Help individuals avoid highly processed foods and refined ingredients.

Summary : This WELL feature requires adequately limiting sugar and refined grains in all foods and beverages.

Issue : Poor diets, characterized by highly processed foods with added sugars, refined grains and *trans* fats, are the second-leading risk factor for mortality and morbidity globally, accounting for 8% of all deaths and contributing to an estimated 9.6% of the global burden of disease.¹ Sugar consumption, especially added sugar, has been associated with poor diet quality, an increased risk of heart disease, obesity and tooth decay.²⁻⁴ Refining grains removes most of their vitamins, minerals and dietary fiber. Dietary fiber has been linked to a lower risk of heart disease, stroke, hypertension, diabetes and obesity and is associated with improved digestive health.⁵

Solutions : Increasing access to healthier food items includes increasing the availability of healthier alternatives, as well as limiting the availability of highly processed foods. Based on recommendations by the World Health Organization (WHO), on average, adults should consume no more than 25 grams of added sugar per day.² Limiting intake of sugar-sweetened beverages and sugary foods can help individuals meet the WHO sugar recommendations and reduce their daily sugar intake. Promoting the consumption of whole grains by increasing whole grain options can also help individuals increase their intake of dietary fiber.^{4,6}

PART 1 LIMIT TOTAL SUGARS (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

Foods and beverages are sold or provided by (or under contract with) the project owner on a daily basis and meet the following requirements:

- a. Beverages do not contain more than 25 g of sugar per container or serving.²
- b. At least 25% of beverages contain no sugar per container or serving, or drinking water is available at no cost.
- c. Non-beverage food items (except whole fruit) do not contain more than 25 g of sugar per serving.²

PART 2 PROMOTE WHOLE GRAINS (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

Grain-based foods are sold or provided by (or under contract with) the project owner on a daily basis and meet the following requirements:

- a. In at least 50% of grain-based foods (foods that have a grain flour as the first ingredient or that contain $\geq 30\%$ grain ingredients), a whole grain is the first ingredient.⁷
- b. If both whole-grain and refined-grain options are available, whole-grain options do not cost more than their refined-grain counterparts (e.g., brown rice does not cost more than white rice).

Note : Projects must have at least one whole grain option at each food outlet (if grain-based foods are sold or provided) but the 50% calculation may be considered across the entire food service operation (per food category or total number of grain-based foods).

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N04 FOOD ADVERTISING | O (MAX : 1 PT)

Intent : Encourage the selection and consumption of healthier food choices through advertising and messaging.

Summary : This WELL feature requires healthy food advertising and nutritional messaging.

Issue : Billions of dollars are spent annually on food marketing and advertising around the world to overwhelmingly promote highly processed products, including sugar-sweetened beverages, breakfast cereals and fast foods.¹ Food advertising and marketing is ubiquitous and takes several forms, including direct and indirect advertising, product sale contracts and sponsored materials. Children and youth are particularly susceptible to food advertising.² Research has found a strong association between advertising for non-nutritious foods and children's behavioral and mental health.² Exposure to unhealthy food advertising increases food consumption in children but not adults.³ Moreover, the marketing and advertising of high-calorie, low-nutrient foods and beverages increases children's preference and intake of unhealthy foods and beverages.⁴ In adults, exposure to food advertising is shown to influence food choices and eating behaviors.⁵

Solutions : Healthy food advertising has been shown to increase the selection of healthier items and may have a stronger impact than anti-obesity advertising on shaping eating behaviors.⁶ These interventions have been effective in a variety of food settings including, cafeterias, corner stores, grocery stores and supermarkets.⁷⁻¹¹

PART 1 OPTIMIZE FOOD ADVERTISING (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

1: Food advertising

If foods and beverages are sold or provided on a daily basis by (or under contract with) the project owner, the following requirements are met:

- a.
Sugar-sweetened beverages are not advertised or promoted.¹²
- b.
Deep-fried food options are not advertised or promoted.¹³
- c. Deep-fried food options are not displayed under heat lamps.

2: Nutritional messaging

All dedicated eating spaces and points of sale contain at least two different instances of messaging that promote one of the following:

- a. The consumption of fruits and vegetables.¹³
- b.
The consumption of drinking water.^{14,15}

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N05 ARTIFICIAL INGREDIENTS | O (MAX : 1 PT)

Intent : Help individuals avoid artificial colors, flavors, sweeteners and preservatives in foods and beverages.

Summary : This WELL feature requires projects to label and phase out or restrict artificial ingredients.

Issue : Numerous artificial ingredients are typically added to highly processed foods to improve taste and extend shelf life.¹ However, since these additives do not add nutritional value to a food and tend to appear in foods with low nutritional quality, they should be avoided as often as possible. While some artificial ingredients do not carry immediate health risks, they may become toxic when consumed in large quantities and many have not been evaluated for their effects on metabolic regulation or potential contributions to obesity.² Certain artificial dyes that are approved for use in the U.S. may also be carcinogenic, cause hypersensitivity reactions and behavioral problems or be inadequately tested.³ In the EU, for example, foods that contain artificial dyes are required to carry label warnings that they may cause hyperactivity in children.^{4,5}

Solutions : Sourcing packaged foods and beverages without artificial colors, flavors, sweeteners and preservatives can help limit artificial ingredient consumption, as well as promote a diet of whole, natural foods. Labeling and phasing out the use of artificial ingredients that have been deemed ingredients of concern is another way to help individuals avoid consumption of additives. Fortunately, many food companies are phasing out artificial ingredients or reformulating recipes to remove them, a trend partly driven by growing consumer demand and an increased desire for nutritional transparency.⁶

PART 1 LIMIT ARTIFICIAL INGREDIENTS (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

Option 1: Artificial ingredient phase out

Foods and beverages are sold or provided by (or under contract with) the project owner on a daily basis and meet the following requirements:

- a. The project phases out (over a maximum of three years) the use, sale and provision of foods and beverages containing the following artificial ingredients:

Colorings	Blue 1 (E133), Blue 2 (E132), Green 3, Orange B, Citrus Red 2, Red 3 (E127), Red 40 (E129), Yellow 5 (E102), Yellow 6 (E110), carmine, cochineal, caramel coloring
Sweeteners	acesulfame-potassium (acesulfame-k), advantame, aspartame, calcium saccharin, saccharin, sucralose, cyclamate, neotame, polydextrose
Preservatives	sodium nitrate, sodium nitrite, potassium bromate, potassium iodate, propyl gallate, BHA (butylated hydroxyanisole), BHT (butylated hydroxytoluene), TBHQ, sodium benzoate
Fats & Oils	BVO (brominated vegetable oil), partially hydrogenated oil, olestra
- b. Foods and beverages are clearly labeled on packaging, nearby menus or signage to indicate whether they contain artificial ingredients listed in the table above.

OR

Option 2: Artificial ingredient restriction

The following requirements are met:

- a.

All foods and beverages sold or provided by (or under contract with) the project owner on a daily basis do not contain artificial ingredients listed in the table below:	
Colorings	Blue 1 (E133), Blue 2 (E132), Green 3, Orange B, Citrus Red 2, Red 3 (E127), Red 40 (E129), Yellow 5 (E102), Yellow 6 (E110), carmine, cochineal, caramel coloring
Sweeteners	acesulfame-potassium (acesulfame-k), advantame, aspartame, calcium saccharin, saccharin, sucralose, cyclamate, neotame, polydextrose
Preservatives	sodium nitrate, sodium nitrite, potassium bromate, potassium iodate, propyl gallate, BHA (butylated hydroxyanisole), BHT (butylated hydroxytoluene), TBHQ, sodium benzoate
Fats & Oils	BVO (brominated vegetable oil), partially hydrogenated oil, olestra

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N06 PORTION SIZES | O (MAX : 1 PT)

Intent : Promote healthy portion sizes and reduce unintended overconsumption and food waste.

Summary : This WELL feature requires reduced-size food options when food is sold or provided and limits dishware sizes when food is self-serve.

Issue : The portion and packaging sizes of many foods have increased significantly over the last 30 years along with rising global obesity rates.^{1,2} Research suggests that individuals consistently consume more food and drink when offered larger-sized portions, packages or tableware, than when offered smaller-sized versions.³ Larger packaging, meal sizes and dishware sizes are possible contributors to growing portion sizes, especially when portion and serving sizes do not align.

Solutions : Smaller portion size options for meals and individual food items can encourage reasonable portions without infringing on individual choice.⁴⁻⁶ Reducing the portion size of foods and beverages that are not nutrient dense, such as processed foods, can help individuals maintain calorie balance and reduce added sugar consumption.⁷ Dishware sizes can also be adjusted to promote healthier portion sizes. Larger dishware is associated with larger self-served portions and greater energy intake in both adults and children.^{3,8,9} Individuals also tend to underestimate the quantity of food when it is presented on a larger plate and overestimate the quantity when it is presented on a smaller plate.^{10,11} Though the effect of plate size may vary based on an individual's body weight or gender, it may have more influence when purposely used to guide appropriate portions.^{8,12,13}

PART 1 PROMOTE HEALTHY PORTIONS (MAX : 1 PT)

For Commercial Dining Spaces:

Foods and beverages are sold or provided by (or under contract with) the project owner on a daily basis and meet the following requirements:

- a. All standard menu items do not contain more than 650 kCal, or a version or portion of the standard menu item is available at a smaller size and lower cost for at least 50% of all standard menu items containing more than 650 kCal.
- b. Where food is self-serve (e.g., buffet), dishware does not exceed the following sizes per occupant type:

Dishware	Primary School Students	Secondary School Students	Adults
Circular plates, diameter	20 cm	25 cm	25 cm
Non-circular plates, surface area	314 cm ²	507 cm ²	507 cm ²
Bowls, volume	240 mL	355 mL	473 mL
Cups, volume	240 mL	355 mL	473 mL

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N07 NUTRITION EDUCATION | O (MAX : 1 PT)

Intent : Support a healthy eating pattern by increasing nutritional knowledge and food literacy.

Summary :
This WELL feature requires the provision of nutrition education.

Issue : Food literacy is defined as an individual's ability to not only understand nutrition information but also to implement this knowledge into their diet through preparation and cooking of food and healthy meals.¹ Studies report a positive relationship between food literacy levels and healthy dietary intake. Unfortunately, due to a global dietary shift away from whole ingredient foods, such as fruits and vegetables, and towards highly processed foods that require little-to-no skill in preparation and cooking, many people lack adequate food literacy to make healthy choices.² Therefore, nutrition and food education programs focused on increasing levels of food literacy are important to individual health and well-being. Participation in food and nutrition education programs have been associated with increased fruit and vegetable intake, knowledge of food preparation skills, and improvements in healthy behaviors.³⁻⁷

Solutions : Nutrition education has been shown to be more effective when focused on changing specific behaviors, rather than only increasing knowledge.^{8,9} Nutrition education is also more effective when combined with environmental dietary modifications, such as strategic placement of healthier alternatives, portion size control and menu modifications.³ Educational programming that includes multiple types of interventions (mixed-method programming) and that is on-going or longer term has a greater impact than short-term, single-method interventions.^{3,5} The scope of nutrition and food education may also be broader than personal nutrition and health. For example, education can cover topics, such as safe food handling practices, gardening and food production techniques, as well as food preparation skills.

PART 1 PROVIDE NUTRITION EDUCATION (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

At least one of the following is offered live (in-person or virtually) to regular occupants at no cost on a quarterly basis at minimum:

- a. Cooking demonstrations led by chef-instructors that include fruits and/or vegetables, demonstrate cooking skills and integrate hands-on learning opportunities.
- b. Nutrition or dietary education sessions led by an accredited dietitian or accredited nutritionist.
- c. Individual nutrition consultations led by an accredited dietitian or accredited nutritionist.
- d. Gardening or planting workshops focused on edible plants that integrate hands-on learning opportunities.

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N08 MINDFUL EATING | O (MAX : 2 PT)

Intent : Encourage mindful eating behaviors and communal dining opportunities.

Summary : This WELL feature requires dedicated eating space that contains tables and chairs and the provision of daily meal breaks.

Issue : Our eating behaviors are influenced by a variety of factors that extend beyond just hunger. Additional factors that influence our food choices, include economic, social, psychological and environmental determinants. Recently, eating alone and distracted eating have become emerging social concerns and are associated with a variety of social and health outcomes. Studies have found that people who tend to eat alone may be more likely to choose healthier foods, eat fewer fruits and vegetables and eat at irregular times.¹ Eating alone may also be a potential risk factor for metabolic syndrome, a group of risk factors that increase the risk of heart disease, stroke and diabetes.^{2,3} There is also some evidence to indicate that distracted eating while working, reading, watching television or listening to music is associated with higher food intake both immediately and later on.⁴

Solutions : Eating attentively and placing focus on the process of eating may lead to better control of one's food intake. A positive relationship also exists between mindful eating and mental well-being.⁴ The provision of dedicated eating spaces can encourage individuals to enjoy meals together, prevent distracted eating at workstations and lead to better eating habits. In addition to eating spaces, having designated meal periods can help ensure individuals have and take time to eat meals mindfully.

PART 1 SUPPORT MINDFUL EATING (MAX : 2 PT)

For All Spaces except Dwelling Units:

1: Dedicated eating space

A dedicated eating space is located within a 200 m walk distance of the project boundary and meets the following requirements:

- a. Contains tables and chairs to accommodate at least 25% of regular occupants at peak occupancy. If multiple dedicated eating spaces are present, the combined seating space must accommodate at least 25% of regular occupants at peak occupancy.
- b. Provides protection from environmental elements (e.g., direct sunlight, rain, wind) or is in a climate-controlled space.
- c. Accommodates a variety of seating arrangements, including small group (up to 4 people) and large group (more than 4 people) seating.

2: Daily meal breaks

The following requirement is met:

- a. Eligible employees and students (as applicable) have a daily meal break of at least 30 minutes.

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N09 SPECIAL DIETS | O (MAX : 2 PT)

Intent : Provide alternative food choices to individuals with dietary restrictions, food allergies or intolerances, and label common food allergens.

Summary : This WELL feature requires the provision of meal alternatives and food allergen labeling.

Issue : Individuals with food allergies, intolerances or dietary restrictions may encounter difficulty in finding suitable meal options outside of the home setting. The World Allergy Organization reports that the prevalence of food allergies is increasing in countries around the world.¹ A growing number of individuals are also omitting certain ingredients or following special diets for a variety of personal, health, social and environmental reasons.² Such dietary exclusion or restriction may have nutritional consequences and lead to a nutritionally deficient diet.^{3,4} Dietary guidelines increasingly recognize a variety of healthy eating patterns, such as the Mediterranean-style and vegetarian eating patterns, that can help ensure an individual's diet is both nutritionally adequate and enjoyable.⁵

Solutions : Meal alternatives for common food allergies or intolerances and dietary restrictions can help accommodate individual dietary preferences and ensure the availability of meal options and balanced meals for everyone. Alternatives can minimize the stress and worry associated with food and dietary restrictions. Suitable meal options can also minimize the risk of individuals consuming potentially harmful foods. To further reduce barriers to special dietary needs, alternative food items can be offered at the same or similar price as standard items. Ingredient transparency through accurate food allergen labeling can help individuals identify and avoid potential allergens.

PART 1 ACCOMMODATE SPECIAL DIETS (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

Meals with main dishes are sold or provided by (or under contract with) the project owner on a daily basis and include at least one option that meets the following requirements:

- a. Does not contain peanut and tree nuts.
- b. Does not contain gluten and wheat.
- c. Does not contain soy.
- d. Does not contain sesame.
- e. Does not contain animal products, including seafood, dairy, and eggs.

PART 2 LABEL FOOD ALLERGENS AND INTOLERANCES (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

Foods and beverages are sold or provided by (or under contract with) the project owner and all foods and beverages are clearly labeled at point-of-decision (e.g., on packaging, menus, signage) to indicate if they contain the following common food allergens and intolerances:⁶

- a. Peanut.
- b. Fish.
- c. Shellfish.
- d. Soy.
- e. Milk.
- f. Egg.
- g. Wheat.
- h. Tree nuts.
- i. Sesame.
- j. Gluten.

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N10 FOOD PREPARATION | O (MAX : 1 PT)

Intent : Provide space and supportive amenities for the preparation of meals on-site.

Summary : This WELL feature requires a food preparation area, storage space and other amenities to support the reassembly or reheating of meals on-site.

Issue : Consumption of foods away from home has steadily increased since the 1970s.¹ This is a concerning trend, since meals consumed away from home are often higher in calories, lower in nutrients and larger in portion size.² Emerging research has found an association between eating away from home and a higher BMI and lower fruit and vegetable consumption in adults.³ Analysis of dietary intake data also shows that individuals who bring food from home tend to have a better diet quality than individuals who purchase food away from home.² In addition to nutritional benefits, preparing meals at home has financial benefits. Frequent home cooking is linked to reduced food expenditures, whereas frequently eating away from home is associated with higher food expenditures.⁴

Solutions : Spaces that allow individuals to reheat or assemble food prepared at home can support healthy eating habits and cooking skills. Sufficient cold storage space can ensure safe food storage to accommodate the storage needs of individuals who bring meals from home. Other supportive amenities, such as eating utensils and devices for reheating food can make it even easier for individuals to consume homemade meals and encourage healthy eating patterns.

PART 1 PROVIDE MEAL SUPPORT (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces except Dwelling Units, Commercial Kitchen Spaces & Guest Rooms:

The following supportive amenities are provided in a quantity that meets employee demand in at least one dedicated eating area within a 200 m walk distance of the project boundary:

- a. Cold storage.
- b. Countertop surface.
- c. Sink and amenities for dish and hand washing.
- d. Device for reheating food (e.g., toaster oven, microwave).
- e. Dedicated cabinets or storage units available for employee use.
- f. Non-plastic plates, bowls and cups.
- g. Spoons, forks and knives.
- h. Cans/bins for garbage, recycling and/or compost.

For Dwelling Units:

The following supportive amenities are provided:

- a. Countertop surface.
- b. Sink.
- c. Refrigerator.
- d. Cabinets.
- e. Stove with hood vented directly to the outdoors.

For Guest Rooms:

The following are available for guest use in each guestroom:

- a. Refrigerator/mini-fridge (not counting refrigerators dedicated to items that can be purchased).
- b. Microwave oven.
- c. Bowls, cups and utensils, including spoons, forks and knives.
- d. Dish soap.

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N11 RESPONSIBLE FOOD SOURCING | O (MAX : 1 PT)

Intent : Reduce dietary exposure to pesticides, hormones and antibiotics, limit environmental degradation and promote humane livestock practices.

Summary : This WELL feature requires sourcing and labeling certified organic and certified sustainable foods.

Issue : The use of antibiotics and hormones on animals and pesticides on produce is a global threat to public health and the ability to treat infectious diseases. Studies have confirmed that the use of antibiotics in agriculture and animals contributes to the development of antibiotic resistance in humans, and dietary pesticide exposure has been associated with adverse reproductive consequences in women and men.¹⁻⁴ The consumption of certain pesticides has also been linked to an increased risk for some types of cancer, and pregnant women exposed to higher amounts of pesticides have given birth to children with lower IQ.⁵⁻⁷

Solutions : Responsible sourcing practices and policies can help promote sustainable, ethical and socially responsible food purchases and promote animal welfare. While organically grown foods may not be significantly more nutritious than conventionally grown foods, organic produce has been shown to have lower levels of pesticide residue and organic chicken and pork are less likely to contain antibiotic-resistant bacteria than conventional food.⁸ Animal welfare standards serve to ensure that animals are raised in humane conditions and address topics such as space allowance, transportation, feed and outdoor access provided for farm animals.⁹ Humane practices also limit the use of antibiotics and hormones on animals. Labeling organic and humanely raised foods can help individuals quickly identify these products, as well as promote local farms and organizations.

PART 1 IMPLEMENT RESPONSIBLE SOURCING (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

1: Sustainable sourcing

Foods and beverages are sold or provided by (or under contract with) the project owner on a daily basis and the total product line meets the following criteria:

- a. At least 50% of the total produce line (fruits and vegetables) is certified organic.¹⁰
- b. At least 25% of the total animal product line (meat, seafood, egg and dairy products) is certified organic, Certified Humane® or certified by a GSSI-recognized Seafood Certification Scheme.^{9,10}

2: Sustainable labeling

Sustainable and humane agriculture is promoted through the following, as applicable:

- a.
Certified organic and sustainable products are labeled at point-of-decision.
- b.
Local farms or sources are advertised at point-of-decision for locally sourced foods.

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N12 FOOD PRODUCTION | O (MAX : 2 PT)

Intent : Provide opportunities for on-site food production and increase food access.

Summary : This WELL feature requires the provision of space, infrastructure and tools for on-site food production.

Issue : Changing economic and environmental conditions, along with increasing industrialization, have led to both a physical and emotional disconnect between consumers and their food. Most food is produced or processed hundreds of miles from where it is consumed, often threatening local food systems and contributing to a sense of detachment. More recently, consumers have an increasing desire to know how their food is made, raised or grown, in order to better understand the consequences of their food purchases.¹ This has led to the growth of a global movement committed to reconnecting individuals, communities and local food systems.

Solutions : Increasing access to locally grown food is important for many reasons, including food access and social and environmental health. Individuals who participate in community and home gardening projects have higher levels of fruit and vegetable consumption and are more likely to meet national recommendations for fruit and vegetable intakes than nongardeners.²⁻⁴ Individual participation in community agriculture has also been linked to increased household fruit and vegetable intake. ² Beyond contributing to nutritional benefits, gardens are associated with several social benefits. Participation in community gardening can help fortify social cohesion and community involvement, increase physical activity, provide on-site educational opportunities and increase perceptions of community safety.^{3,5} Gardening may also benefit mental health, by reducing symptoms of anxiety and depression.⁶

PART 1 PROVIDE GARDENING SPACE (MAX : 2 PT)

For All Spaces except Dwelling Units:

A permanent and accessible space for food production is located within a 400 m walk distance of the project boundary and meets the following requirements:

- a. The space includes at least one of the following:
 1. Garden or greenhouse with food-bearing plants.⁷
 2. Edible landscaping (e.g., fruit trees, herbs).⁷
 3. Hydroponic or aeroponic farming system.
- b. The space is available to regular occupants during the majority of building operating hours. Foods grown are made available to regular occupants.
- c. The space is at least 0.09 m² per regular occupant or 0.05 m² per student, whichever area is greater (up to a maximum of 140 m² and not less than 18.5 m²). The area calculated is the actual growing area (vertical or horizontal) used for the production of food-bearing plants.⁷ For hydroponic and aeroponic farming systems, the project may halve the growing area calculations, given higher yield.
- d. Regular occupants have access to planting supplies, including planting medium, watering system, lighting (interior spaces only), plants and gardening tools.⁷

For Dwelling Units:

A permanent and accessible space for food production is located within a 400 m walk distance of the project boundary and meets the following requirements:

- a. The space includes at least one of the following:
 1. Garden or greenhouse with food-bearing plants.⁷
 2. Edible landscaping (e.g., fruit trees, herbs).⁷
 3. Hydroponic or aeroponic farming system.
- b. The space is open to regular occupants during regular building hours and is accessible the majority of the days in the operating year. Foods grown are made available to regular occupants.
- c. The space is at least 1.4 m² per dwelling unit (up to a maximum of 140 m² and not less than 18.5 m²). The area calculated is the actual growing area (vertical or horizontal) used for the production of food-bearing plants.⁷ For hydroponic and aeroponic farming systems, the project may halve the growing area calculations given higher yield.
- d. The space provides planting supplies, including planting medium, watering system, lighting (interior spaces only), plants and gardening tools.⁷

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N13 LOCAL FOOD ENVIRONMENT | O (MAX : 1 PT)

Intent : Increase access to fresh, local and seasonal fruits and vegetables by reducing environmental barriers.

Summary : This WELL feature requires projects to take into consideration the local food environment during site selection or programming.

Issue : Dietary patterns around the world are influenced by a complex mixture of personal, cultural and environmental factors, including the local food environment. The local food environment encompasses the type and density of food retail outlets, including grocery stores and food service outlets, and the consistent availability of healthy, wholesome foods at these venues. However, certain environments have the potential to be more obesogenic than others, promoting weight gain and possibly contributing to obesity.¹ In particular, the presence of smaller grocery stores and fast food establishments influence food choices and is associated with a higher prevalence of obesity.²

Solutions :

Locating projects within close proximity to supermarkets, grocery stores and farmers markets can help individuals improve their dietary and lifestyle behaviors, through environments that support better food choices.^{2,3} Hospitals and healthcare institutions that host farmers' markets and farm stands contribute to healthier nutrition environments by positively impacting fruit and vegetable consumption, an effective model that may be generalizable to other large institutions.^{4,5} Beyond farmers' markets, increased healthy food retail outlet density is associated with a lower BMI, while supermarket availability is associated with meeting dietary recommendations.⁶⁻⁹ Mobile food markets, food carts and fruit and vegetable stands are additional ways to increase access to fruits and vegetables in the environments where individuals live, work and learn.⁴

PART 1 ENSURE LOCAL FOOD ACCESS (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

Option 1: Supportive environment

The main building entrance is located within a 400 m walk distance of one of the following:

- Supermarket or store with a fresh fruit and vegetable section.¹⁰
- Farmers' market that is open at least once a week and operates for at least four months of the year.¹¹

OR

Option 2: Supportive programming

The project meets one of the following requirements:

- Serves as a distribution point for a community-based agriculture program that delivers fruits and vegetables at least twice a month for at least four months of the year, in which regular occupants can participate.¹¹
- Hosts the weekly sale of fruits and vegetables (e.g., fruit and vegetable carts or stands, mobile markets) for at least four months of the year.¹²

OR

Option 3: Supportive transportation

The project meets the following requirement:

- Transportation is provided at no cost between the project and a supermarket and/or store with a fresh fruit and vegetable section and/or farmers market.

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N14 RED AND PROCESSED MEATS | O (MAX : 1 PT)

Intent : Increase the availability of plant-based food options and reposition red and processed meat products to decrease their prominence at point-of-decision.

Summary : This WELL feature requires providing plant-based food options, limiting the portion size of red meat and decreasing the prominence of red and processed meats.

Issue : The consumption of meat, including red and processed meat, has been increasing worldwide, a trend with major health and environmental consequences.¹ In 2015, the World Health Organization classified processed meat as carcinogenic (cancer-causing) and red meat as probably carcinogenic.² Processed meat includes meat that has been processed through salting, smoking, curing or other processes to improve flavor or preservation while red meat includes unprocessed mammalian muscle meat such as beef, veal, pork and lamb.² Although red meat is a source of protein and minerals and vitamins, such as iron and vitamin B12, many studies show that a high intake of red meat is associated with an increased risk of colorectal cancer, heart disease, diabetes and other chronic diseases.²⁻⁴ Consumption of processed meat is more strongly associated with colorectal cancer and also positively associated with stomach cancer.² Globally, food production practices that support the consumption of plant-based foods, including meat alternatives, are more likely to contribute to a sustainable food system and healthier environment for all.⁵

Solutions : Providing plant-based meat alternatives, reducing the portion size of red meat servings and repositioning meat products has the potential to decrease the demand for and consumption of meat.⁶ The World Cancer Research Fund recommends that individuals who consume red meat limit their intake to no more than three portions per week (equivalent to 350–500 g per week) and to avoid eating processed meat.⁷ Plant-based protein sources such as nuts, legumes (pulses) and cereals (grains) as well as poultry, fish, eggs and dairy are valuable sources of protein and nutrients and are recommended alternatives to red meat.⁷ Smaller portions and leaner cuts of red meat are also encouraged for individuals who normally consume red meat.⁷ In food service, chefs and menu developers can help shift eating patterns by positioning red meat as a supplement (side dish) or condiment to plant-based dishes and by limiting processed meat options.⁸

PART 1 LIMIT RED AND PROCESSED MEATS (MAX : 1 PT)

For Commercial Dining Spaces:

Foods and beverages are sold or provided by (or under contract with) the project owner on a daily basis and meet the following requirements, as applicable:

- a. At least one plant-based option is available at each food outlet.⁸
- b. A single portion or serving of red meat, if sold or provided, is less than 150 g uncooked weight or less than 115 g cooked weight.⁷
- c. Red and processed meats, if sold or provided, are placed at the end of self-serve food service lines.⁶
- d. Red and processed meats, if sold or provided, are listed last in each menu section or listed on a separate menu and/or menu board.⁹

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